

10 quotes that said it all

Some politicians were word perfect, echoing their times

1 Indira Gandhi 1979

"The Janata Government is afraid of a tiny woman like me because I want to improve conditions in the country. If the country prospers, even a little by doing away with me, I am willing to be hanged."

2 Indira Gandhi 1984

"I will serve the country till the last drop of my blood."
In Orissa, a day before her assassination

3 Rajiv Gandhi 1985

"India is an old country, but a young nation, we are impatient. I am impatient and I too have a dream of an India—strong, independent, self-reliant..."
To the US Congress

4 Rajiv Gandhi 1985

"Millions of ordinary Congress workers are full of enthusiasm. But they are handicapped, for on their back ride the brokers of power and influence..."
At the Congress centenary session in Mumbai

5 V.P. Singh 1988

"I would be a disaster as a prime minister."
In the year the Janata Dal was formed

6 Lalu Prasad Yadav 1991

"There is no wave, only Lalu wave in Bihar."
In the run-up to the general elections

7 Dr Manmohan Singh 1991

"No power on earth can stop an idea whose time has come."
In his maiden speech as Union finance minister, quoting French writer Victor Hugo

8 Atal Bihari Vajpayee 1998

"I've waited 40 years. Now it's my turn."
After the results of the Lok Sabha elections were announced

9 Sonia Gandhi 2004

"I have often stated, that the post of prime minister is not my aim. My inner voice tells me I must humbly decline this post."
While declining the position of prime minister at the Congress Parliamentary Party meet

10 Sitaram Yechury 2005

"The Left is not the lap dog or pet dog of anybody, but the watch dog. When it barks, the Government will have to listen."
Issuing yet another threat from the Left to the government

10 things better left unsaid

They shot into the headlines with this, but not happily so

1 D.K. Barooah 1976

"Indira is India, India is Indira."

2 Bal Thackeray 1979

"Bombay is a prostitute that people leave behind after satisfying their needs without saying as much as a thank you."

3 Devraj Urs 1979

"I regret your having denied me the honour of receiving it in a virgin state and allowing the press a honeymoon with it before it landed in my arms..."
Replying to a show-cause notice from Indira Gandhi

4 Indira Gandhi 1981

"What sort of freedom do these people want? To paint a wrong picture? To distort the truth?"

5 Giani Zail Singh 1982

"If Madam would ask me to sweep the floor, I would not hesitate to do so."
Declaring his loyalty to Prime Minister Indira Gandhi after she chose him to be the President of India

6 Rajiv Gandhi 1984

"When a big tree falls, the earth shakes."
After Indira Gandhi's assassination

7 Rajiv Gandhi 1984

"Don't read newspapers. They are writing blatant lies."
To the students of Visva Bharati University, Shantiniketan

8 George Fernandes 2002

"Gujarat is no reflection on Hindutva, it's a riot. Women being raped isn't something new."

9 Sonia Gandhi 2007

"... Sach toh ye hai ki Gujarat ki sarkar main jhoote, beimaan aur maut ke saudagar hain."
(The Gujarat government has liars, cheaters and men who deal in death)

10 Sheila Dikshit 2008

"One should not be too adventurous."
After journalist Soumya Viswanathan was murdered when returning home from work late at night